Eli Cochrane

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EDUCATION

University of Kansas – Lawrence, KS
B.A., Psychology & Political Science **| B.S.,** Data Science Expected May 2027
Cumulative GPA: 4.0/4.0
Certificate: Mind and Brain Studies
Political Science & Psychology Honors Thesis: *Psychological Defense & Group Identification: A Computational Language Framework*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social psychology, political cognition, group dynamics, computational linguistics, natural language processing, social media discourse, identity threat response, narrative group identity

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (2026). Masculinity, Meaning, and Misogyny: Linguistic Markers of Intra- and Intergroup Identity Threat in r/JordanPeterson. [In Review].

- Analyzed 209,500 Reddit posts from 2017-2024, examining identity threat, group-based identity processes, language choice, and political polarization in online communities, focusing on how the source of an identity threat predicts linguistic behavioral responses.
- Implemented topic modeling (BERTopic), dictionary-based analysis (LIWC-22), latent profile analysis (TidyLPA), and a LIWC-based measure of unquestioning affiliation to quantify temporal shifts in group identity process and radicalization.
- Supported by an Undergraduate Research Award from the University of Kansas.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (2026). Conspiracy Theories as Intelligence Performance: The Roles of Social Context, Impression Motivation, and Personality. [In Preparation].

- Designed and administered a preregistered 2x2 between-subjects experiment examining whether social signaling motivations affect linguistic expressions of conspiracism.
- Developed a multi-method computational natural language processing pipeline integrating LLM-based conspiracism ratings, LIWC-22 psycholinguistic analysis, and scale-based belief internalization measures.
- Supported by an Undergraduate Research Award from the University of Kansas and a Portz Interdisciplinary Fellowship from the National Collegiate Honors Council.

Cochrane, E. & Haider-Markel, D. (2026). News Media and Political Elite Attention and Framing, 2015-2026. In Flores, A., Haider-Markel, D., Lewis, D., Miller, P., & Taylor, J. (Eds.), *Transgender Wars: Understanding Transgender Rights in the Early 21st Century*. University of Michigan Press. [In Preparation].

- Invited to collect and analyze data for a first-authored book chapter.
- Developed Python scripts to extract and structure legislation text, congressional floor transcripts, and television advertisement transcripts mentioning transgender issues.

- Developed R scripts to perform LASSO regression on LIWC-22 variables, analyzing how linguistic framing of transgender movements differ by political party across ten years.
- Supported by two Allan J. Cigler Political Science Academic Enrichment Awards.

Cochrane, E. & Haider-Markel, D. (2026). LGBTQ+ Interest Groups. In *The SAGE Encyclopedia of Interest Groups and Lobbying.* [In Press].

- Invited to collaborate on a review article for SAGE Publications Inc.'s Encyclopedia of Interest Groups and Lobbying.
- Reviewed and synthesized the history of and literature on interest groups and lobbying efforts focused on the advancement of LGBTQ+ civic rights in America.
- Supported by an Allan J. Cigler Political Science Academic Enrichment Award.

HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS, & AWARDS

Academic Honors

- McCluskey-Fawcett Outstanding Honors Contribution Award — Spring 2026
- Psi Chi Membership — Spring 2026
- University Scholars — Spring 2026
- Phi Kappa Phi Membership — Fall 2025
- Phi Alpha Theta Membership — Spring 2025
- University of Kansas Dean's List (semesterly) — Fall 2024 – Present
- KU Chancellor Merit Scholarship (semesterly) — Fall 2024 – Present

Research Awards

- Portz Interdisciplinary Fellowship — Fall 2026
- NSF-GRFP Application Workshop Fellowship — Fall 2026
- KU Spring Symposium Best in Panel Award — Spring 2026
- KU Psychology's Best Independent Research Project Award — Spring 2026
- SPSP Undergraduate Student Poster Award — Spring 2026
- Alexander Family Undergraduate Research Award — Spring 2026
- SPSP Diversity Undergraduate Registration Stipend — Fall 2025
- KU Research Travel Award — Fall 2025
- Jack & Lavon Brosseau Honors Opportunity Award — Fall 2025
- Allan J. Cigler Political Science Research Award (semesterly) — Fall 2025 – Present
- Undergraduate Research Award — Summer 2025
- KU Spring Symposium Outstanding Research Presentation Award — Spring 2025

Public Service Awards

- U.S.-Sino Leadership & Global Engagement Award — Summer 2025

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (Forthcoming in Feb. 2027). Psychological Defense & Group Identification: A Computational Language Framework. Poster at the Computational Psychology Preconference at the annual meeting of the *Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP),* Philadelphia, PA.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (Forthcoming in Feb. 2027). Conspiracy Theories as Intelligence Signaling: Modeling Social Context, Impression Motivation, and Individual Differences. Single Presenter Symposium Talk at the annual meeting of the *Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP),* Philadelphia, PA.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (July 2026). Masculinity, Meaning, and Misogyny: Linguistic Markers of Intra- and Intergroup Identity Threat in r/JordanPeterson. Parallel talk at the *International Conference on Computational Social Science,* Burlington, VT.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (April 2026). Masculinity in Community: Analyzing Identity Construction Discourse in r/JordanPeterson. Poster presentation at the University of Kansas's *Symposium for Undergraduate Psychology Engagement & Research*, Lawrence, KS.

- Received a Best Independent Research Project Award.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (April 2026). Savviness Signaling and the Public Inflation of Conspiracy Beliefs. Oral presentation at the *Spring Undergraduate Research Symposium,* University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

- Received a Best in Panel Award.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (April 2026). Savviness Signaling and the Public Inflation of Conspiracy Beliefs. Oral presentation at the *Student Research Conference in the Psychological Sciences,* Kansas City Kansas Community College, Kansas City, KS.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (Feb. 2026). Masculinity in Community: Analyzing Identity Construction Discourse in r/JordanPeterson. Poster presentation at the annual meeting of the *Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP),* Chicago, IL.

- Received SPSP's Undergraduate Student Poster Award.

Cochrane, E. & Forth, C. (April 2025). Masculinity, Meaning, and Modernity: An Investigation into Jordan B. Peterson's Appeal to Male Ontological Insecurity. Oral presentation at the *Spring Undergraduate Research Symposium,* University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

- Received an Outstanding Presentation Award.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

LEMMA Lab, University of Kansas Aug. 2025 – Present
Principal Student Investigator | Mentor: Mark Landau, PhD, Social Psychology

- Developing an honors thesis and NSF-GRFP proposal exploring the linguistic markers of psychological threats in social media responses to natural disasters, as well as their relationship to group identity and prosocial behavior.
- Leading a study examining the use of analogy in interpersonal contexts to understand the social aspects of episodic memories' mental representations and their recall.
- Leading a study exploring self-presentation and conspiracy belief expression, focused on a novel hypothesis considering the social-beneficial role of conspiracy theories.
- Led a study utilizing natural language processing techniques to identify patterns in responses to identity threats in online masculinity-centered communities.
- Mentoring undergraduate research assistants to facilitate research skill-building, build qualitative coding schema, and administer online and in-person laboratory studies.

Political Science Department, University of Kansas Aug. 2025 – Present
Principal Student Investigator | Mentor: Don Haider-Markel, PhD, Political Science

- Using LIWC-22 and logistic regression to map changes in language use among political elites for a book chapter on transgender rights in the media and political institutions.
- Developed Python scripts to scrape and structure legislation, advertisement transcripts, and congressional transcripts and analyze linguistic framing of transgender individuals.
- Co-authored a SAGE encyclopedia entry on the historical development of LGBTQ+ interest groups, focusing on clearly communicating research to broad audiences.
- Analyzed American National Election Survey data on public opinion toward LGBTQ+ rights to understand the belief-level influence of campaign strategies and political events.

Molina Lab, University of Kansas Aug. 2025 – May 2026
Research Assistant | PI: Ludwin Molina, PhD, Social Psychology

- Executed semi-structured qualitative interviews to investigate Americans' narrative identities concerning debt, economic inequality, and the American Dream.

English Department, West Texas A&M University June 2025 – Aug. 2025
Research Assistant | PI: Bonnie Roos, PhD, English

- Conducted qualitative research on James Joyce's *Dubliners*, synthesizing close textual reading with psychological frameworks of colonial subjectivity and ontological security.

Trade War Lab, University of Kansas Dec. 2024 – May 2025
Research Assistant | PI: Jiakun Jack Zhang, PhD, Political Science

- Employed statistical analysis in R to explore U.S.-China trade relations through bilateral policies, tariffs, and macroeconomic trends that affect international dynamics.

History Department, University of Kansas June 2024 – Aug. 2025
Principal Student Investigator | Mentor: Christopher Forth, PhD, History

- Conducted interdisciplinary political psychology research analyzing the intersection of historical masculinity norms, online discourse, and political radicalization to build a framework for future projects on identity and politicized masculinity.
- Developed an interest in NLP to efficiently process large-scale textual data, inspiring a research program focused on computational techniques for analyzing group identity.

INVITED TALKS & SYMPOSIA

Cochrane, E. (Forthcoming Nov. 2026). Conspiracy Theories as Intelligence Performance: The Roles of Social Context, Impression Motivation, and Personality. Invited talk at the *Professional Seminar for the University of Kansas's Department of Social Psychology*, Lawrence, KS.

Cochrane, E. (Oct. 2026). The Theory & Practice of Computational Text Analysis. Invited guest lecture and interactive workshop in *LING 176: First Year Linguistics Seminar: Towards Linguistic Justice*, Lawrence, KS.

Cochrane, E. (Sep. 2026). The Theory & Practice of Computational Text Analysis. Invited colloquium presentation at the *Linguistics Colloquy Series hosted by the University of Kansas's Department of Linguistics*, Lawrence, KS.

Cochrane, E. (Aug. 2026). Address to First-Year KU Honors Students. Invited talk at the *2026 Honors Program Convocation*, Lawrence, KS.

Cochrane, E. (July 2026). Political Polarization and Discourse. Invited chaired symposium at the *International Conference on Computational Social Science*, Burlington, VT.

Cochrane, E. (Feb. 2026). The Role of Informational Norms in Online Social Conformity. Invited talk at the *KU Honors Common Cause Symposium*, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

Cochrane, E. (Feb. 2025). Big Tech & Democracy. Invited panelist at *KU Center for Service Learning's Educate & Act panel series,* University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

Cochrane, E. (Feb. 2025). How do Artificial Intelligence Programs Make Moral Decisions? Invited talk at the *KU Honors Common Cause Symposium,* University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

VOLUNTEERING & SERVICE

Founder & Co-President, Kansas Research Collective Jan. 2026 – Present

- Founded a group for research-oriented undergraduate students at KU to connect with each other and share advice for publishing and presenting independent research projects.
- Building a network of undergraduate researchers supporting one another, especially encouraging research excellence and healthy relationships with academia.
- Implementing peer-to-peer services to enhance student outreach, including via website design, event planning, office hours, and research-focused class presentations in collaboration with the KU Honors Program and the Center for Undergraduate Research.

UN Common Cause Student Design Team, KU Honors Aug. 2024 – Jan. 2025

- Developed an interdisciplinary exploration of AI's moral decision-making process in fulfillment of the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals.

TEACHING & MENTORING

Teaching Assistant, Experimental Social Behavior Capstone (PSYC 622) Aug. 2026 – Present

- Invited to assist the capstone undergraduate course in experimental social psychology, focusing on introducing students to computational approaches in social research.
- Aiding students in the development of their identity as a researcher through conversations about research processes, accessible methodologies, and professional development.

Teaching Assistant, Social Psychology (PSYC 360) Jan. 2026 – May 2026

- Partnered with faculty to refine course pedagogy, optimizing syllabus layout and topic selection to enhance undergraduate engagement.
- Worked with students to ensure feedback translates into meaningful course adjustments that facilitate their understanding of social psychology.

UN Common Cause Peer Mentor, KU Honors Aug. 2025 – Jan. 2026

- Led discussions on UN Sustainable Development Goals to create actionable plans to meet sustainability goals in the local community and support mental wellbeing.

Seminar Assistant, KU Honors Aug. 2025 – Dec. 2025

- Guided discussion for HNRS 190: Secrets of Conspiracy Theories to ensure students understood and engaged with class material.
- Assisted students in creating a project for KU Honors' First-Year Seminar Symposium that effectively communicated conspiracy theory research.

RELEVANT SKILLS

Natural Language Processing: LIWC-22, BERTopic, embeddings, LLM annotation, UMAP

Open Science: Preregistration (AsPredicted), open code and materials (Git/GitHub, OSF)

Statistical Modeling: Inferential statistics, regression models, latent profile analysis, interrupted time series, survey-weighted estimation, reliability, structural equation modeling, power analysis

Programming: Python (pandas, numpy, scikit-learn, matplotlib, nltk, pytorch), R (tidyverse, ggplot2, Quarto, psych, easystats)

Survey Deployment: Survey design (Qualtrics), online recruitment (Prolific)

Certifications: CITI Social & Behavioral Research Ethics

Languages: English (native), French (intermediate)